

Case Study: "TechTiffin – A Startup Story"

A group of final-year CS students at a university noticed that many of their classmates struggled to find affordable and healthy lunch options during long coding sessions. Food delivery apps were expensive, and hostel food lacked variety.

Seeing this gap, they came up with "TechTiffin" — a mobile app that connects students to nearby home-based cooks who prepare fresh, healthy lunch boxes daily. Instead of competing with big food chains, TechTiffin focuses on **student-specific needs, customization, and budget-friendly pricing.**

The founders analyzed their target segment carefully:

- Primary users: university students
- Secondary users: faculty & nearby office employees

They used **Blue Ocean Strategy** by targeting **non-customers** who don't regularly order from restaurants. They highlighted their **USP**: "*Fresh, home-style meals delivered at student prices.*" Within the first two months, TechTiffin gained over 500 active users. They are now exploring how to scale their idea to other universities.

Multiple Choice Questions

1. If TechTiffin wants to defend its USP as competitors enter the space, which of the following would be the strongest strategic move?

- A. Increasing discounts aggressively
- ☒ B. Building network effects through exclusive university partnerships
- C. Launching expensive advertising campaigns
- D. Copying features from bigger competitors

2. If TechTiffin uses a data dashboard to track daily meal orders and optimize delivery routes, this is an example of:

- A. Technological innovation supporting value delivery
- ☒ B. Innovation in the product's core value proposition
- C. Entrepreneurial mindset shift
- D. USP enhancement by emotional storytelling

3. Which of the following best describes how TechTiffin created value for its target market?

- A. By offering cheaper food than all competitors
- B. By focusing on emotional branding instead of functionality
- ☒ C. By highlighting the pain point of the target audience redefining the existing food delivery market space
- D. By relying on traditional competitive differentiation strategies

4. Which of the following best differentiates TechTiffin's entrepreneurial approach from a typical intrapreneurial initiative?

- A. It operates under a university department
- ☒ B. It focuses on building within an existing firm
- C. It's driven by external opportunity recognition and risk-taking
- D. It relies entirely on internal organizational resources

5. In identifying "healthy, fresh, at your doorstep, affordable meals for students," the founders demonstrated which element of the entrepreneurial mindset?

- A. Opportunity recognition through trend imitation
- B. Risk avoidance and resource control
- ☒ C. Pattern recognition and problem framing
- D. Competitive intelligence gathering

6. TechTiffin's decision to focus on non-restaurant customers aligns most closely with which strategic principle of Blue Ocean Strategy?

- A. Focus on lowering costs alone
- B. Value innovation by reconstructing market boundaries
- ☒ C. Product diversification through incremental change
- D. Aligning with industry cost structures

7. TechTiffin's innovation can be best classified as:

- A. Technology-driven innovation with breakthrough R&D
- ☒ B. Market-driven innovation that solves a pain point
- C. Incremental innovation in backend operations only
- D. Radical technological disruption of the food sector

8. TechTiffin segmented their customers carefully (students vs faculty). This primarily supports:

- A. Crafting investor pitches
- B. Identifying relevant KPIs
- C. Positioning their USP effectively
- D. Reducing their operational costs

Creative Slogan Question

Imagine TechTiffin is about to **expand to multiple universities across Pakistan**.

Write a short **catchy slogan** that could be used on their app banner or social media to attract their target market.

"Enjoy ~~the~~ ~~at~~

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